

Day 4 — Dinacharya (Daily Routine)

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students recall the components of *dinacharya* (waking, oral hygiene, oil massage, exercise, meals, sleep) and articulate the principle behind each.

Materials

- Wall chart of dinacharya timeline
- Whiteboard

Vocabulary

- *Dinacharya* — daily routine (literally “day’s conduct”)
- *Brāhma muhūrta* — “Brahma’s hour,” ~96 min before sunrise (recommended wake time, traditionally)
- *Abhyanga* — oil self-massage
- *Vyāyāma* — exercise

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Daily prompt + recall: dosha balance principle from yesterday.

Core (25 min)

1. **The dinacharya timeline** (build on the board, in order):

Time	Practice	Why
Brāhma muhūrta (before sunrise)	Wake	Body’s natural alertness peak
Just after waking	Drink warm water	Stimulates digestion, aids elimination
Morning	Oral hygiene (tongue scraping, oil pulling)	Removes overnight buildup
Pre-bath	Abhyanga (warm oil self-massage)	Calms Vāta; nourishes skin
Morning	Exercise (vyāyāma) — up to 50% capacity	Builds Pitta; doesn’t deplete
Mid-morning	Largest meal of the day	Digestive fire (Pitta) is strongest

Time	Practice	Why
Evening	Light dinner, before sunset (ideally)	Aligns with digestive rhythm
Night	Sleep by 10pm	Aligns with Kapha → Pitta night cycle

2. **The principle:** the day is divided into Kapha (6am–10am), Pitta (10am–2pm), Vāta (2pm–6pm), then repeating. Each time block has dominant dosha character. Activities aligned with the block work with the body, not against it.

3. **Modern science overlap:**

- **Circadian biology** (Aschoff 1965, Nobel Prize 2017 to Hall, Rosbash, Young) — confirms ~24-hour rhythms in metabolism, hormones, sleep.
- **Time-restricted eating** (Satchidananda Panda’s work) — confirms larger meal earlier is metabolically better.
- **Sleep science** — confirms sleeping by ~10pm aligns with melatonin curve.
- **Oil massage** — emerging evidence on skin barrier, lymphatic drainage.

4. **The honest framing:** Many dinacharya practices align with modern lifestyle medicine. The framework was figured out from observation centuries before modern measurement.

Read primary source (5 min)

BG 6.17: > *yuktāhāra-vihārasya yukta-ceṣṭasya karmasu* > *yukta-svapnāvabodhasya yogo bhavati duḥkha-hā*

“He who is regulated in eating, recreation, work, sleep, and waking can mitigate sorrow.”

(Read aloud once. Won’t fully analyse today — that’s Day 7.)

Activity (8 min) — Map your dinacharya

Each student writes their CURRENT daily routine in the dinacharya timeline format. Notice where it aligns and where it doesn’t.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- Preview Day 5: “Tomorrow — mid-module check + project topic.”

Homework

- Pick ONE dinacharya practice you don’t currently do. Try it tomorrow. Note how it felt.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read about Panda’s time-restricted eating research. Note overlap with dinacharya meal timing.
- **Tier down:** Focus on 3 practices: wake with sun, eat largest meal mid-morning, sleep by 10pm.

Teacher notes

- The “brāhma muhūrta wake time” is *traditionally* recommended but unrealistic for many students. Don’t push.
- The science overlap is real; don’t oversell (“Ayurveda predicted everything”). The honest framing: “tradition observed; science measured; they agree on much.”

Citation(s) used

- BG 6.17 — vidya-karana RAG cache day-04-dinacharya.json#chunks[0].
- Panda, S. (2018). *The Circadian Code*. Rodale. (Modern alignment.)